

B.T. Franklin

Phoenix, Arizona

Applied AI Technical Lead

602-247-0439 | brandon.franklin@gmail.com

btfranklin.info • github.com/btfranklin

Professional Summary

Applied AI technical lead and software architect with 20+ years of experience across enterprise software, developer tooling, and product-facing systems.

- Focused on generative AI, large language models (LLMs), agentic systems, and AI product architecture.
- Experienced in moving emerging AI capabilities into useful engineering workflows and product experiences.
- Combines full-stack engineering depth with product thinking, UX sensibility, technical leadership, and published computational creativity research.

Core Expertise

Applied AI and Large Language Model (LLM) Systems; Agentic Workflow Design and Agent Evaluation; AI Product Architecture; Developer Experience and Platform Tooling; Full-Stack Product Engineering; Technical Leadership.

Professional Experience

Zilliant, Inc.

AI Tech Lead / Staff Software Engineer

April 2025 - Present

- Serve as organization-wide AI technical leader, guiding engineering teams on adoption of large language models (LLMs), agents, evaluation practices, and modern AI development patterns aligned with business goals.
- Architected the company's first Model Context Protocol (MCP) server and directed implementation by a third-party contractor, opening new enterprise revenue opportunities.
- Drove broad adoption of AI tooling across engineering, contributing to a significant increase in developer productivity.

Software Architect

August 2022 - March 2025

- Designed and implemented a custom generative AI pipeline that enabled real-time integration of diverse pricing insights into customer-facing analytics experiences.
- Led integration of AWS QuickSight and Amazon Q, improving data visualization capabilities, accelerating user adoption, and enhancing customer decision support.

Earlier Zilliant Engineering Roles

January 2009 - August 2022

- Directed UI/UX strategy for enterprise Salesforce implementations, improving usability and aligning product experiences with business objectives across globally distributed teams.
- Contributed across full-stack engineering, Salesforce modernization, strategic proof-of-concept development, and long-running product evolution.

Founder-Led and Open Source AI Work

- **RepoZest:** Building an AI-powered organizational intelligence platform for GitHub repositories that analyzes architecture, contributor expertise, repository history, and live development activity to produce actionable engineering insights.
- **Hiredar:** Conceived, architected, and launched an AI recruiting platform focused on resume parsing, structured candidate extraction, and AI-assisted candidate-to-role matching.
- Built and published open-source AI and developer tooling spanning agent orchestration, AI grounding, prompt engineering, and engineering automation, including agentic-django, compendiumscribe, and promptdown.

Research and Publications

Published computational creativity research in the *Proceedings of Generative Art Conference* and *Proceedings of the 3rd Computer Simulation of Musical Creativity Conference*, covering AI-driven storytelling and generative music systems.

Education

Transylvania University, Lexington, KY: BA in Computer Science, 1997; Minor in Psychology; Graduated with Honors; Recipient of the Computer Science Award.

Skills

Programming Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, Apex, Swift

Technologies: LLM Applications, Agentic Systems, Model Context Protocol (MCP), REST APIs, Salesforce Lightning, AWS QuickSight, Amazon Q, Visual Studio Code, oclif